2024年12月四级真题第1套

原卷 / Question Paper · 年份 2024 | 月份 12 | 第 一 套 | 时长 125 分钟 | 满分 710（及格 425）

Part I 写作 (Writing)

Directions: Suppose the business school of your university is conducting a survey to collect students’ opinions on the express delivery service industry in China. You are to write a response about its recent development and its impact on people's lives. You will have 30 minutes to write the essay. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.

建议时间：30 分钟 | 字数：120-180 | 分值：15

作答区

Part II 听力理解 (Listening Comprehension)

Section A news

短新闻

听力音频：audio/SectionA.mp3（见离线包 papers 目录对应 audio 文件夹）

1. **What do we learn about Sherry Christian?**
   - A. She is making a special effort to be recognized.
   - B. She has been living in Fayetteville for 25 years.
   - C. She has been driving a school bus ever since 2009.
   - D. She is the longest-serving bus driver in Fayetteville.
2. **What did City officials of Fayetteville want bus drivers to be aware of?**
   - A. The importance of their service to the city.
   - B. The number of riders they serve in the city.
   - C. The new proclamation issued early this week.
   - D. The significance of the event to take place March 18.
3. **What does the news report say the Wilton School Board has done?**
   - A. Budgeted $56.7 million for the coming school year.
   - B. Requested to raise teachers’ salaries by 3 percent.
   - C. Proposed a spending increase by 5.99 percent.
   - D. Kept raising funds for at least 8 budget cycles.
4. **What will a decline in the total enrollment lead to?**
   - A. Decrease in salaries for school administrators.
   - B. Reduction in federal and state funding.
   - C. Firing of less qualified faculty members.
   - D. Closing down of some less competitive schools.
5. **What do we learn about thunderstorms from the report?**
   - A. They often take place in the Scottish Highlands.
   - B. They usually happen in the middle of the night.
   - C. Their damage can be as serious as that of bombs.
   - D. Their loud claps can be confused with explosions.
6. **What did the police do when they received the local residents' phone calls?**
   - A. They sent out a message to calm them down.
   - B. They promised to stop the construction work.
   - C. They told them the military exercise was over.
   - D. They set off to inspect the site of the plane crash.
7. **What were people advised to do when traveling outside?**
   - A. Keep warm.
   - B. Take caution.
   - C. Avoid driving.
   - D. Use rail service.

Section B conversations

长对话

听力音频：audio/SectionB.mp3（见离线包 papers 目录对应 audio 文件夹）

1. **What does the woman say she was actually wondering about?**
   - A. Why the man is so anxious to buy a new phone.
   - B. How the man could possibly afford a new phone.
   - C. How the man got into the habit of being wasteful.
   - D. Why the man is so fond of using his credit card.
2. **Why is the man a little embarrassed by the phone he's using now?**
   - A. It is not in fashion any more.
   - B. It goes out of order frequently.
   - C. It is not as fancy as his colleagues’.
   - D. It lacks functions office work requires.
3. **What does the man say about the credit card he just got?**
   - A. It enables him to buy a new phone at a more favorable price.
   - B. It is a special offer to recent college graduates working in offices.
   - C. It is available to office workers who have a good enough credit score.
   - D. It allows him to borrow money without paying interest for six months.
4. **What do we learn about one of the woman's colleagues?**
   - A. She borrowed money to pay her debt.
   - B. She developed a habit of overspending.
   - C. She enjoys buying a lot of fancy things.
   - D. She regrets ignoring the woman’s advice.
5. **What does the tiny home movement mainly advocate?**
   - A. Blog writing and natural resources saving.
   - B. Joint efforts to improve the local community.
   - C. Audience participation in The Morning Show.
   - D. Home ownership and environmental protection.
6. **What does the woman say about houses as small as 20 square meters?**
   - A. Not a realistic size for families.
   - B. Not welcomed by most Americans.
   - C. Only fit for families of four or less.
   - D. Only suitable for renting to the poor.
7. **What does the man think about the dream of owning a 150 square meter house?**
   - A. It should be changed.
   - B. It isn’t easy to realize.
   - C. It will come true sooner or later.
   - D. It doesn’t appeal to average families.
8. **What does the man say about tiny homes?**
   - A. They help to lower housing prices.
   - B. They help to save up for larger houses.
   - C. They are a good choice for many people.
   - D. They are vital to reducing waste worldwide.

Section C passages

听力篇章

听力音频：audio/SectionC.mp3（见离线包 papers 目录对应 audio 文件夹）

1. **What do children seem to have a natural desire to do?**
   - A. Play outdoors and enjoy themselves.
   - B. Beat challenges and take risks.
   - C. Take care of their well-being.
   - D. Grow up strong and healthy.
2. **According to the American Psychological Association, what does regular physical activity do to children?**
   - A. Enable them to develop their motor skills.
   - B. Help them to conceal their frustration.
   - C. Reduce their stress and depression.
   - D. Prevent them from feeling lonely.
3. **What does the passage say about cultivating the habit of physical activity?**
   - A. It begins early.
   - B. It proves demanding.
   - C. It calls for lifelong efforts.
   - D. It lies in nature experiences.
4. **When are job seekers willing to explore jobs with lower salaries according to a new study?**
   - A. When companies share their information online.
   - B. When their job search criteria are met fully.
   - C. When companies embrace greater diversity
   - D. When they find job postings visually attractive.
5. **What did participants see in the baseline condition of the study?**
   - A. Emails in the normal format.
   - B. Major companies in one location.
   - C. All companies in the same sector
   - D. Various aspects of a company’s workforce.
6. **What does the passage say participant seem to be paying attention to?**
   - A. Job security
   - B. Potential pay raises.
   - C. Minimum base salary.
   - D. Information about diversity.
7. **What does the passage say about the findings of a new study from Oregon State University?**
   - A. Positive.
   - B. Original.
   - C. Important.
   - D. Surprising.
8. **What does a growing body of evidence show according to the passage?**
   - A. Dogs match their behavior with kids as much as with adults.
   - B. Kids and adults alike find in dogs a source of attachment.
   - C. Kids’ attitude to dogs is influenced by adults.
   - D. Dogs can help kids in many ways.
9. **What did Monique Udelle say their study suggests?**
   - A. Dogs pay much attention to the kids they live with.
   - B. Dogs view both adults and kids as social companions.
   - C. Kids differ from adults in their behavior towards dogs.
   - D. Kids need to be aware of the risks in playing with dogs.
10. **What does research show kids are very capable of doing?**
    - A. Understanding dogs.
    - B. Training dogs.
    - C. Taking care of dogs.
    - D. Associating with dogs.

Part III 阅读理解 (Reading Comprehension)

Section A 选词填空

Word Bank（词库）

A) actually
B) approximately
C) assume
D) component
E) comprehend
F) deteriorate
G) equivalent
H) journey
I) literary
J) performed
K) rarely
L) sample
M) undermined
N) unique
O) unit

When Toni Morrison died in 2019, the world lost one of its most influential authors. But Morrison was not an early success. Her first novel was not published until she was 39, and her last appeared when she was 84. And Morrison was not __26__ in this regard. Numerous writers produce masterpieces well into their 70s and beyond. Such __27__ accomplishments highlight an important point. Our capacity to speak, write and learn new vocabulary does not seem to __28__ with age. Our eyesight may dim and our recall may weaken, but by comparison, our ability to produce and to __29__ language is well preserved into older adulthood.

Indeed, the latest research that has emerged on language and aging shows that language mastery is a __30__ that we begin as infants and continue on for the rest of our lives. Some aspects of our language abilities, such as our knowledge of word meanings, __31__ improve during middle and late adulthood. One study, for example, found that adults over sixty had an average vocabulary size of over 21,000 words. The researchers also studied a __32__ of college students and found that their average vocabulary contained __33__ 16,000 words. In another study, older adults, with an average age of 75, __34__ better than participants in their youth or middle years on tasks that required them to determine the meaning of words. Thus, language seems to be a skill that, contrary to what many might __35__, does not weaken with age.

空格题号：26、27、28、29、30、31、32、33、34、35

Section B 段落匹配

Directions: 阅读下列段落，为每个句子选出所对应的段落。每个段落可能被选一次、多次或不被选择。

A Few topics have been so endlessly analysed as work-life balance. The quest to attain this mysterious state has dominated discussion around careers for years—especially for working parents. The concept is often presented as something to achieve, or a goal to reach. And once you’ve reached it, congratulations: you've made it; you're a successful human being of the 21st century.

B But the problem is that we often tell ourselves: “I'm going to put in eight hours’ worth of work, and then I'm going to put in eight hours’ worth of ‘me time’, which will include my family, my hobbies, my workout, my everything,” says Anat Lechner, clinical associate professor of management at New York University. “I don’t think it’s such a simple formula.”

C And, according to new findings, it may not be. Some researchers are now encouraging us to stop thinking about work-life balance as an achievement that you either hit or don’t. Instead, they suggest it may be more of a lifelong process—a continuous, never-ending exercise that requires self-awareness and timely adjustments. Researchers Ioana Lupu and Mayra Ruiz-Castro argue that work-life balance is “a cycle, not an achievement” In their 2020 study, the researchers interviewed nearly 80 employees at two London-based firms—an equal number of men and women between the ages of 30 and 50, all with at least one dependent child—who worked in middle or senior management roles.

D Although it sounds like the respondents had a lot in common, here’s what separated them: about 30% of the men and 50% of the Women reported resisting working long hours. The other respondents, meanwhile, all worked long hours because they thought that’s what successful professionals should do.

E Lupu and Ruiz-Castro looked at those who rejected the long hours and they found that those workers actually had strikingly similar strategies for maintaining their work-life balance. They had a tendency to reflect and question assumptions in the name of self-awareness and regularly took steps to adjust the things standing in their way to work-life balance.

F Lupu and Ruiz-Castro identified five steps that the respondents in the study who had better work-life balance used in their jobs. First, they paused and reconsidered beliefs such as “I'm a professional, so I should work, work, work”, and asked themselves questions like, “What’s currently causing me stress?” Second, after identifying the cause, they zeroed in on their resultant emotions. Did they feel angry, sad, energised? Third, they reprioritised, asking “Is working long hours really worth cutting back on family time?”, for example. Fourth, they considered their alternatives: is there anything at work that could be changed to accommodate these new priorities? And finally, they implemented changes, like asking their supervisor for greater flexibility, or deciding not to take on every project that comes their way.

G This five-step process is something anyone can adopt. Going through the steps, and constantly checking in with yourself can help you shift and adapt your professional life to something that will better harmonise with your personal one. “Awareness of your emotional state is essential in order to determine the changes you want to make in your work and in your life,” says Lupu.

H New York University’s Lechner agrees that finding that balance is an ongoing pursuit. It’s not simply about dividing up the hours in your day between work, the gym, kids and chores. If the underlying emotional sources of stress are still there, then the time you actually spend at home may not be enjoyable. “We come home and even though physically we are there, mentally we still may be processing things that happened at work. We're not present,” she says. What we call “work-life balance” is actually just a substitute to having a sense of fulfillment and contentment.

I Of course, finding that balance probably shouldn’t be something you have to do by yourself. Research by Erin Kelly, professor of work and organisation studies at MIT, shows companies and managers can play a key role in creating a better environment for workers. For her book Overload: How Good Jobs Went Bad and What to Do about It, she and co-author Phyllis Moen split more than 1,000 employees at a Fortune 500 company into two groups, one that worked under a management redesign and one that continued working within the existing management structure.

J Under the management redesign, many steps were taken to ensure better work-life balance and prevent burnout (精疲力竭). Managers were regularly reminded to explicitly support their employees. Workers were allowed to make changes, like cancelling 9 am meetings. All of this was done in the name of increasing job satisfaction and giving workers greater flexibility, and to assure workers that it was something management was committed to. Unsurprisingly, Kelly and Moen found that employees in the redesign group reported less stress and less burnout. They were less likely to quit their jobs; indeed, over the next four years, they were 40% less likely to quit than those who kept working under the old policies.

K “Work-life balance is understood to be an individual’s response, so people think ‘it’s up to me to manage the craziness of my work life’”, says Kelly. But organisations need to examine the demands they’re placing on employees. “The root problem is not how the two pieces of work and life come together. It’s that we have unrealistic expectations of what we’re asked to do on the work side.” If your workplace isn’t an environment where work-life balance is possible in the first place, any effort you attempt to make toward it on a personal level will be in vain.

L That’s a conversation that appears to be gathering pace. The new prevalence of remote and flexible working models will likely all play important roles in how we balance our professional and personal lives. And if it seems like finding that perfect balance remains difficult to achieve, the experts say that keeping some perspective can help. For millions of people, work is about being able to put food on the table. Talking about work-life balance “is a very privileged conversation”, says Lechner. “If we’re reflecting, maybe we should also reflect on that.”

待匹配句子

36. According to a management expert, work-life balance is not as simple as giving equal amounts of time to work and personal life.

37. Research found that those who are given greater flexibility at work are less stressed and more likely to stay in their jobs.

38. Workers who rejected working long hours tended to make regular adjustments in order to achieve work-life balance.

39. Talking about work-life balance is said to be a privilege reserved for the better-off, not for those who barely make a living.

40. Knowing one’s emotional state is of utmost importance in deciding what changes to make for a better work-life balance.

41. More female professionals reported being reluctant to work overtime than their male counterparts.

42. Without organisational support, any personal effort to maintain work-life balance will be unsuccessful.

43. The question of how to achieve work-life balance has long been the main subject of discussion among workers.

44. You may not actually experience emotional wellbeing at home if you remain occupied with what happened at work.

45. Some researchers suggest that work-life balance is not a goal to achieve, but a process for life to be adjusted promptly.

Section C 阅读理解

Passage One

The weakening of the human connection to nature might be good for economic growth but is bad for people. A tipping point was reached in 2020 when human-made materials — such as steel, concrete and plastic — were found to weigh more than all life on Earth. Continuing to grow concrete forests rather than real ones is shortsighted. Simply being in the nearest wood has such health benefits that the Woodland Trust successfully lobbied for it to be prescribed by doctors.

Yet slipping from popular culture is the wonder and beauty of the natural world. For every three nature-related words in hit songs of the 1950s, researchers found, there was only slightly more than one 50 years later. It is not a moment too soon that teenagers will be able to take a natural history test given that for decades children have been able to name more video game characters than wildlife species.

Part of remedying this social disease would be for parliament to pass a “right to grow” law, allowing anyone to turn underused public spaces into vegetable and fruit gardens. The idea is for people to get back in touch with the soil — while producing food sustainably.

Vegetable planting has a respectable tradition. In April 1649, locals responded to high prices and food shortages by cultivating vegetables on common land in Southern England. The practice of throwing seed bombs to turn vacant plots of land green took off in 1970s New York, and has been revived (使复活) by green-thumbed (有园艺才能的) social media influencers who defy local US regulations in a war on ugly spots in cities.

Apart from the urgent task of providing more healthy nutrients to those who increasingly can’t afford them. Publicly accessible fruit and vegetable gardens connect what we eat to where it comes from—the means of production, if you will. They can make unlovely spaces lovely, and marry use and beauty as well as help promote a sense of community. Plants are also, of course, our first defense against species loss and climate change. Such planting is a small step for humanity — in the right direction.

1. **What does the author want to emphasize in the first paragraph?**
   - A. The year 2020 was a big turning point in human history.
   - B. Economic growth benefits people little in the long run.
   - C. It is unwise to weaken the human connection to nature.
   - D. It is harmful to mankind to use human-made materials.
2. **What did researchers find about popular culture?**
   - A. It is increasingly detached from the natural world.
   - B. It is filled with all kinds of video game characters.
   - C. It is especially appealing to the taste of teenagers.
   - D. It is still impacted by the hit songs of the 1950s.
3. **What does the author propose people do?**
   - A. Take measures to ensure sustainable food development
   - B. Reconnect with nature through the right to grow.
   - C. Stand by the parliament in fighting social diseases.
   - D. Cover public spaces with fruit trees and vegetable plants.
4. **What do we learn from the passage about vegetable planting?**
   - A. It all started in 1649 in Southern England.
   - B. It is protected by US government regulations.
   - C. It has long been used to increase food supply and improve urban landscape.
   - D. It has been popularized worldwide with the increasing influence of social media.
5. **What can publicly accessible fruit and vegetable gardens do apart from their practical functions?**
   - A. Raise people’s environmental awareness.
   - B. Add to the great variety of plant species.
   - C. Act as the first defense against natural disasters.
   - D. Enhance people’s community spirit.

Passage Two

Engineering in the U.S. has long been a male-dominated profession. Fifty years ago, it looked like that might change. In 1970, the percentage of women majoring in engineering was less than 1%. In 1979, that number was 9%. Many hoped women would continue to enter the field at the same rate. But that’s not what happened. Today, only 21% of engineering majors are women, a number largely unchanged since 2000.

I am a historian who, along with my colleagues, surveyed 251 women engineers who graduated from college in the 1970s. These pioneers reflected on the challenges they faced — and had advice for women entering the field today.

One survey taker explained, “The greatest challenge for me was continuing to believe in myself, when all the messages I was getting were that I would never be taken seriously or promoted or given raises at the same rate as men, who were clearly less qualified and not as smart as I was.”

A chemical engineer who worked in manufacturing agreed, “You have to prove yourself just because you are female. And you have to work twice as hard!”

A civil engineer said, “We are ‘women engineers.’ People don’t refer to a man as a ‘man engineer’ — he’s an engineer. We are constantly reminded that we don’t truly belong.” Another civil engineer stated, “On many levels, you’re never quite one of the groups.”

Women also talked about family caregiving responsibilities. A retired vice president from a major chemical company stated, “Young women engineers are on an equal footing until they have children, then they struggle to balance work and family—and compete with men who don’t have the same household responsibilities.”

But over the years, things have changed a lot. Young women engineers are more accepted mostly because there are just more of them. Many women engineers hailed the benefits of their chosen career. A program manager in manufacturing stated that engineering is the best degree. A mechanical engineer said, “It will give you the flexibility to do almost anything. It is also satisfying to see the effects of what you have done.”

1. **What does the passage say about the engineering profession in the United States?**
   - A. It has seen a change in attitude towards women engineers since 1979.
   - B. It witnessed a significant increase in women engineers in the 1970s.
   - C. It has experienced the gradual weakening of male dominance.
   - D. It boasted the largest number of engineering majors in 2000.
2. **What does one survey taker say was her greatest challenge?**
   - A. Not to feel superior to less qualified male engineers.
   - B. Not to take seriously all the messages she was getting.
   - C. Not to think highly of her qualifications when promoted or given a pay raise.
   - D. Not to lose self-confidence though constantly discouraged or unfairly treated.
3. **How do women engineers frequently feel according to the two civil engineers?**
   - A. Disqualified on many levels.
   - B. Excluded from the group.
   - C. Overworked by their organizations.
   - D. Looked down upon by male colleagues.
4. **What probably makes young women engineers more accepted nowadays?**
   - A. Their success in gaining an equal footing.
   - B. Their ability to balance work and family.
   - C. The change in their responsibilities.
   - D. The increase in their number.
5. **What can we conclude about many female engineers from the statement of a mechanical engineer?**
   - A. They take great pride in their chosen career.
   - B. They have reaped the benefits of being flexible.
   - C. They enjoy doing engineering to the best degree.
   - D. They have proved capable of doing almost anything.

Part IV 翻译 (Translation)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English.

中国政府十分重视环境保护。近年来,中国在减少空气、水和土壤污染上取得了显著成效。为了不断改善人们的生活环境,中国采取了一系列有效措施,包括大力发展清洁能源,改善公共交通,推广共享单车,实施垃圾分类。通过这些措施,中国的城市和农村正在绿起来、美起来。中国还积极参与国际合作,为全球环境保护做出了重要贡献。

建议时间：30 分钟 | 分值：15

作答区